

Meaning Of Ibadah

The word 'Ibadah' an Arabic word, came from its root word: 'ABD' so we are slaves (Ibad) of Allah (SWT), and we are created for performing 'Ibadah'. Allah (SWT) said:

"I created the jinn and mankind only that they might worship (perform 'Ibadah) to Me", [Surah Al-Jariath/ 51:56].

Mustafa Ahmad Zarqa said: 'Ibadah according to Islam, 'Ibadah is a meaning for purification of man's soul and his practical life.

Imam Mohamed Baianonie said: The 'Ibadah in Islam means: The ultimate obedience, the ultimate submission and the ultimate humility to Allah (SWT) along with the ultimate love for Him [Allah (SWT)].

Al-Zajaj said: The meaning of Al-Ibadah: Obedience with submission.

Al-Zamakhshari said: Al-Ibadah: The most extreme level of submission and lowering one's self.

Allah (SWT) said:

"Say: Truly, my prayer and my service of sacrifice, my life and my death, are (all) for Allah (SWT), the Cherisher of the Worlds".

Clear concept of 'Ibadah in Islam: Ibadah in Islam is understood in comprehensive meaning. So the concept of ibadah in Islam means which works and activities are included in the word Ibadah. If we think deeply then we can understand that all of our activities are maybe included in the terms of Ibadah. If we follow the rules of Islam and fulfill the conditions of Ibadah because main aim of the creation is none but only to serve Allah (SWT) and this is Ibadah. Allah (SWT) said:

"I created the jinn and mankind only that they might worship (perform 'Ibadah) to Me", [Surah Al-Jariath/ 51:56].

Islam looks at the individual as a whole. He is required to submit himself completely to Allah (SWT), as the Qur'an instructed to the Prophet (SAAS) Muhammad to do. Allah (SWT) said:

"Say (O Muhammad) my Prayer, my sacrifice, my life and my death belong to Allah (SWT); He has no partner and I am ordered to be among those who submit, i.e. Muslims".

Conditions of Ibadah

Conditions of 'Ibadah (for being acceptable by Allah) are divided into two types: (a) Main or primary conditions and (b) Secondary conditions.

[1] Main Conditions (Primary): Main conditions of 'Ibadah in Islam are Five (05), these are:

(a) Iman: 'Iman' is to believe in all things which Prophet (SAAS) Muhammad (SWT) came from Allah (SWT) in our Soul, agree in our Mouth, and practice in our practical life. It is said in the Holy Qur'an:

"And We shall turn to whatever deeds they did (in this life), and We shall make such deeds as floating dust".

(b) Ikhlas: Ikhlas means to practice all works only to get satisfaction of Allah (SWT). Allah (SWT) said:

"Say, Indeed I have been commanded to perform 'Ibadah to Allah (SWT) making the 'Deen' sincerely for Him alone".

(c) Mutaba'tur Rasul: 'Mutaba'tur Rasul' means to follow our Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) in our practical life. Allah (SWT) said:

“Say, Obey Allah (SWT) and His Messenger: But if they turn back, Allah (SWT) will not love those who reject faith”.

(d) Pure intention

(e) Ilm (knowledge)

[2] Secondary Conditions: After discussing main conditions of ‘Ibadah, there are few secondary conditions for accepting ‘Ibadah before Allah (SWT), these are:

- (1) Avocation through valid way
- (2) To save ourselves from disobedience of Allah (SWT)
- (3) To save ourselves from disobedience of parents
- (4) To save ourselves from showing & hearing
- (5) To fulfill ‘Ibadah with heart and soul
- (6) Practicing all good deeds
- (7) Favour from Allah (SWT)
- (8) Fulfilling pre-conditions of some Ibadah

Some Muslim scholars added: A necessary Condition of ‘Ibadah is Ikhlas (Sincerity). Allah (SWT) said:

“Those who have ‘Iman’ and confuse not their ‘Iman’ with Injustice. For them there will be security and they are the rightly guided”.

He also said:

“Say, Indeed I have been commanded to perform ‘Ibadah to Allah (SWT) making the Deen”.

Characteristics of Ibadah

Characteristics of 'Ibadah are divided into two types: (a) Main characteristics and (b) Secondary characteristics.

[1] Main characteristics of 'Ibadah in Islam:

(1) Generally, Islam is free from intermediaries. Allah (SWT) said:

“And your Lord says: "Call on Me; I will answer your (Prayer): but those who are too arrogant to serve Me will surely find themselves in Hell - in humiliation!"

(2) Islam is a direct link between man and Allah

(3) Religious Scholars in Islam are not intermediaries between man and Allah

(4) Acceptable media in Islam

(5) Hiding knowledge is the greatest sin

(6) Our duty is to do 'Ibadah in all places

(7) Our duty is to do 'Ibadah at all times

(8) Few places are the best place: Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) said:

“To pray in my mosque (Mosque of Prophet in 'Medina') is better than other mosques, except 'Masjid-e-Haram' (The Holy Ka'ba in 'Makkah')”.

(9) Few 'Ibadahs are related to soul

(10) Few 'Ibadahs are related to tongue

[2] Secondary Characteristics:

(1) 'Ibadah is a lifelong service

(2) 'Ibadah is conscious (alert) activities, not just so-called meditation (thought).

Characteristics of Ibadur Rahman

1. The true servants of Allah are those who walk on earth humbly. Allah (SWT) said:

“And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogant”.

2. Who when ignorant people behave insolently (insult) towards them, they say 'peace to you'.

3. Who pass their night in prostrating themselves and standing before their Lord.

4. Who pray for the wellbeing of their close relatives.

5. Who are neither extravagant nor miser. Allah (SWT) said:

“They are those who do good deeds only to be seen (of men) and withhold sharing of utensils”.

6. Who invoke (pray to) not any Lord/Lords but Allah.

7. Who do not kill a soul unjustly, which Allah has forbidden.

8. Who do not commit adultery (Zina).

9. They are those who repent (feel sorrow) after committal of the above sin (as it is a way to get rid of sin).

10. Who (renew) their Iman, or belief once again.

11. Who do righteous deeds.

12. Who do not bear false witness.

13. Who, if ever have to pass by what is vain, pass like dignified (noble) men.

14. Who do not behave like blind and deaf (hard of hearing) when the revelation or sign of their Lord are recited to them for admonition.

15. Who pray for the wellbeing of their offspring and spouses.

Importance of Salah

Salah is the second pillar of Islam; it is considered as the best pillar of Islam, which is compulsory for all Manhood: man and woman. Allah (SWT) said:

“(They are) those who, if We establish them in the land, establish regular prayer and give regular charity, enjoin the right and forbid wrong: with Allah rests the end (and decision) of (all) affairs”.

1. Salah is the 2nd pillar of Islam

2. It is prescribed for all previous Prophets and Messengers

3. Foundation of the religion: Prophet (SAAS) said:

“The Salah is the ‘Amud (foundation) of the religion”.

4. Allah’s (SWT) order

5. Prophet’s order to practice Salah by following him

6. The demarcation between believer and infidel

7. Performing Salah is a sign of successful believer: The Holy Qur'an states:

"The believers must (eventually) win through, those who humble themselves in their prayers".

8. The first question on the Day of Judgment

9. It is the key to Jannah (heaven): Prophet (SAAS) said:

"The key to heaven is Salah, and the key to Salah is Ablution".

10. Miraj of Mumin

11. The best way to get mental satisfaction

12. The best way to become comfort of our eyes

13. Reason of entering the Hell

14. Best way to acquire Taqwa

Lessons/Impacts of Salah

1. All times remembrance of Allah: The Holy Qur'an states:

"Verily, I am Allah: There is no Lord (Allah) but I. So serve thou Me (only), and establish regular prayer for celebrating My praise".

2. To be punctual

3. Cleanness (Clean and pure society and country)

4. Honesty (Honest and loyal society)

5. Humility

6. Blessings of Allah for all
7. Equality between rich and poor
8. Active society
9. Leadership (Following the leader in society)
10. Society of working in leisure (time)

Arkanus-Salah: Pillars of Salah

- 1. Intention:** Declaring the intention of prayer (Niyyah), intention by heart only; not by the tongue.
- 2. At-Takbir At-Tahrima:** Starting Salah by saying 'Allahu Akbar', after it, it is forbidden for him or her to do normal work what is valid for him or her out of Salah, for example: Eating, drinking, talking with another person...etc.
- 3. Al-Qyam (Standing):** If he or she is fit physically then he or she must stand for obligatory prayers, otherwise he or she can seat for performing obligatory Salah.
- 4. Al-Qyirah (Reciting the Holy Qur'an):** Specially Surah Al-Fatihah at all times, and another Surah fully or partly conditionally.
- 5. Ruku (bow down the head):** After reciting the Holy Qur'an we must bow down our head to Allah (SWT) by reciting: **"Subhana rabbi al-a'jim"**.
- 6. Sijdah (prostration):** After Ruku a believer ultimately surrenders to Allah (SWT) and becomes nearer (near) by Him by reciting: **"Subhana rabbi al-a'la"**.

7. Al-Julus al-Akhir (Last sitting for fixed Dua named Tashahhud): We must sit down finally (For reciting the Tashahhud). It is discussed in Hadith:

“{The Prophet (SAAS) said to Allah (SWT)}: “All kinds of greetings, prayers and goodness belong to Allah.”

Importance of Zakah

Zakah is the third obligatory pillar of Islam. Allah (SWT) said:

“And be dedicated in prayer; practice (practice) regular charity; and bow down your heads with those who bow, down in worship”.

1. Zakah is the 3rd foundation of Islam
2. Allah and His messengers order
3. The demarcation between Muslim and Infidel
4. Encouragement for paying Zakah: Allah (SWT) said:

“So establish regular prayer, and give regular charity; and obey the apostle; that you may receive Mercy”.

5. Punishment for abstaining from Zakah
6. Zakah is like the bridge of Islam: Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) said:

“Zakah is the bridge of Islam”.

7. Zakah is an inseparable part of Muslim
8. Zakah is the signs of believers

9. The best way to obtain mental satisfaction
10. The best way to purify our mind
11. The best way to purify our wealth
12. Reason of entering the Hell
13. It is prescribed for all previous Prophets and Messengers

Proper Way to Distribution of Zakah

Who should give Zakah/ Who pays Zakah/ Who is required to pay Zakah:

- (1) Muslim, Adult, sane and free
- (2) They who are rich
- (3) Fulfilling Nisab
- (4) Nisab beyond basic needs
- (5) Remain it under arrest for minimum one year
- (6) Productive nature

The Due Recipients of Zakah:

- (1) Fuqaraa (The poor Muslims)
- (2) Masakeen (Needy Muslims)
- (3) Aamileen: (Zakat collector and distributor)
- (4) Muallafatul Quloob (Reverted Muslim or who wants to revert)
- (5) Ar-Riqaab (The Muslim prisoners of war)

- (6) Al Ghaarimeen (Debtor)
- (7) Fi Sabeelillah (In the way of Allah)
- (8) Ibnus-Sabeel (The Muslim wayfarers)

Importance of Sawm/Fasting

Sawm (fasting) is the fourth or fifth pillar of Islam. Like Salah (prayer) and Zakah (poor-due) Fasting is another important institution of Islam. Allah (SWT) said:

“O you who believe! Fasting is prescribed to you as it was prescribed to those before you, that you may learn self-restraint (self-control)”.

(1) Sawm is the 4th foundation of Islam: Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) said:

“The foundation of Islam is five... (From these) Sawm in Ramadan”.

(2) Sawm is Symbol of belief in Allah (SAAS) and ultimate love for Him

(3) Allah and His Messenger’s order: Allah (SWT) said:

“O you who believe! Fasting is prescribed to you as it was prescribed to those before you, that you may learn self-restraint (self-control)”.

(4) The demarcation between Muslim and Infidel

(5) Getting fixed reward by His (SWT) own hand: Allah (SWT) said:

“Fasting is only for me, and I myself will give him reward for it. (Or I am its reward).”

(6) Opportunity to enter the Jannah (paradise) by a fixed gate

(7) Best way to acquire Taqwa

(8) It is an inseparable part of Muslim

(9) It is the signs of believers

(10) The best way to obtain mental satisfaction

(11) The best way to purify our mind

(12) The best way to purify our wealth

(13) Reason of entering the Hell

(14) Way to get forgiveness of Allah (SWT)

(15) Opportunity to get 'Itiqaf and Night of Qadr

(16) Sawm is related to the revelation of the Holy Qur'an

(17) Protector from many sins: Prophet (Sat) said:

"Sawm is protector".

(18) Glad (joyful) tiding for those who fast: It is said in Hadith:

"For performer fasting, two times when they will be happy: When they take their Iftar (time of breaking fast), and when they will meet will Allah (SWT)".

Impacts of Sawm/Fasting

[1] Social Benefit:

1. To share in hunger

2. To renew the brotherhood between the rich and poor
3. During the Iftar and Tarawih is time to become closer
4. The mosque is a place to make brotherhood
5. Ramadan is totally opportunity to become closer to each other

[2] Physical Benefits:

1. Abstention from foods and drinks for a certain time is the way to physical health
2. Opportunity to do an annual cleaning
3. Protection from toxic matter
4. To make our body fit
5. Protection from the fatty body and make it ready to journey for next year
6. To make us more dutiful

[3] Moral (ethical) Benefits:

1. Making discipline in our life
2. Readiness to obey the direction of Shariah
3. Self-control
4. Controlling our desires
5. Preparation for practicing its teachings out of Ramadan

[4] Spiritual (religious) Benefits:

1. Spiritual exercise and discipline

2. To acquire Taqwa: Allah said:

“O you who believe! Fasting is prescribed to you, so that you may fear Allah (and gain your Taqwa)”.

3. To become closer (private) to Allah and to get reward: Allah (SWT) said:

“Fasting is for me, so I will give the reward for it. (Or I am its reward).”

Importance of Hajj

The fifth (or fourth) pillar of Islam is Hajj. It is obligatory for all capable Muslim, who completes an acceptable Hajj he is as, like innocent baby, who was born just now, Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) said:

“An acceptable Hajj, there is no reward except the heaven”.

1. Hajj is the fifth (or fourth) pillar of Islam
2. Allah and His messengers order
3. The demarcation between Muslim and Infidel
4. The reward of Hajj: Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) said:

“An acceptable Hajj, there is no reward except the heaven”.

5. Punishment for who denies the Hajj
6. Performing Hajj is a sign of Mu'min
7. Opportunity to see the Ka'ba and pray in it
9. Opportunity to visit the Madinah and pray in the Masque of Prophet (SAAS)
10. Combining both body and wealth

Impacts of Hajj

[A] Direct Impact:

1.The teaching of Ihram (wearing the fixed dress with intention of Hajj):

He recites a fixed Dua named ‘Talbiah’ in his mouth as well as his mind by saying:

“LABBAIK ALLAHUMMA LABBAIK, LABBIK LA SHARIKALAKA LABBAIK, INNAL-HAMDA”.

2.The teaching of Tawaf (To circle around Ka’ba with remembering Allah)

3.The teaching of say’ (running between two fixed hills)

4.The teaching of Ukuf (to stay in some places)

5.The teaching of Zimar (throwing stone to symbol of Shaitan): During this time Prophet (SAAS) used to pray by saying:

“O Allah! Make the Hajj an acceptable, and forgive the sins”,

6.The teaching of Nahar (sacrificing animals for Allah)

7. The teaching of Halq (shaving the head) or Taqsir (truncate, cutting as small)

8. The teaching of At-Tawaf Al-Wida (Last Tawaf and to circle around Ka’ba with remembering Allah)

9.The ending (related to how to perform the Hajj)

10. The teaching of maintaining the life according to teachings of Hajj (related to how to perform the Hajj)

[B] Indirect Impact:

1. Generally, it is a worldwide conference

2. Opportunity for meeting together

3. Opportunity for obeying the direction of Allah

4. Establishing the remembrance of Allah
5. Worldwide (international) brotherhood
6. Solving problems of Muslim Ummah
7. Amplification of Islam worldwide
8. It makes us all times prepared for death
9. Taking commitment to establish Allah's religion on the earth